

Viva La Fifa

For a while now, the alternate versions of FIFA have impressed. While *FIFA 10* could not improve much upon the excellent *FIFA 09*, iteration number nineteen, aka *FIFA 11*, had some ground to make up. The PC version of *FIFA 11* this year uses the same game engine as the console (PS3/XBOX 360) version. First look at the game shows the immediate jump EA has made to catch up with *PES 10*, a game we migrated to simply because it made *FIFA 10* look ugly. The players look more real than ever. It is impossible to miss the graphical refinement. Incredibly though, the game has almost zero load time for offline matches.

The most advertised feature of *FIFA 11*'s gameplay has been Personality+ – a new system which imparts attributes to each player, making him both unique and similar to the flesh-and-bone version. Personality+ is no ad gimmick. Smiles spread wide upon seeing such lovely imitation, as Rooney dropped down to midfield like his usual self.

Virtual Pro finally makes it to the PC version, where you can create a player of your choice, tweaking down to minutest details. You can build his attributes in offline matches, and then flaunt him online. The commentary of Andy Gray and Martin Tyler is repetitive and largely un inventive. The game modes can be grouped under offline and online categories.

Offline modes

Besides the regular single player matches/tournaments, Be-a-pro mode offers the alternate player-locked gameplay. You can now be the goalkeeper too; though we found it rather boring after the initial rush settled. 'Be a Pro: Seasons' allows you to go through the season with a player of your choice. Despite all that EA boast of, Manager mode is sterile, to say the least. It does not even compare with the Master League of Pro Evolution Soccer. The realism is absent.

Online Modes

FIFA 11 allows 5v5 in online matches on PC, while the console version gets 11v11 this year. Head-to-head game mode allows ranked/unranked 1v1 game. You can either let the game choose a match for you or you can explore the online lounge/friend list and choose your battle. The process of making matches is smooth and we found that most of our matches had 8-10 player pouring in instantly. FIFA 11 gives full value for your money by enabling you to play not just 1v1 on LAN, like the older version. Now upto 10 of your friends can participate in 5v5 matches on the local LAN.

As a simulation, FIFA still has a few more steps to cover. Some specific passing moves can still be used to pull off easy goals, especially as the passing is slicker with complete 360-degree control. But, this does not take away the fact that with most edges chipped away, this is the best, and one of the toughest FIFA yet.

Genre: Sports

Imported by: Milestone Interactive

Publisher: Electronic Arts

Platform: PC, PS3 and Xbox 360

Price: ₹999 (PC), ₹2,499 (PS3/Xbox360)

